

Hacking and privacy

Every internet user creates data that could be harvested for malicious purposes. It's important to understand the potential pitfalls in order to minimize the risks.

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◀ 156–157 Malware

◀ 186–187 Staying safe online

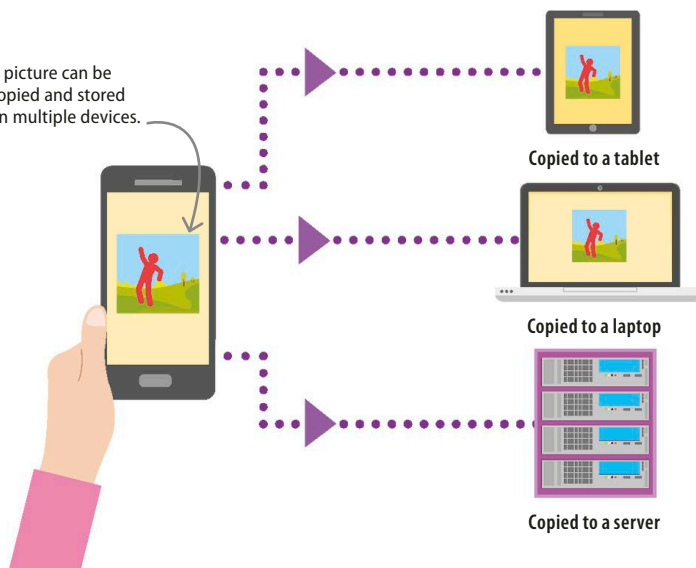
Nothing is private

As a rule of thumb, assume that nothing posted on the internet will be kept private. Account settings might restrict who can view posts on social media, but it's easy enough to download pictures or take screenshots. The pictures can then be shared and re-uploaded at any time. Many websites also have automatic backups, so deleting content only removes it from the main website directory and doesn't necessarily get rid of copies.

▷ Privacy on the internet

To stay safe, avoid posting anything online that you wouldn't be comfortable for strangers to know about you.

A picture can be copied and stored on multiple devices.



Hacking

Making a piece of technology do something it wasn't designed to do is called hacking. A common example is bypassing software security to illegally access someone else's account. There are many types of hacking, but they can all be avoided with the right precautions.

▷ Social engineering

Studying a person's social media account to gain information that could be used to help guess or steal a password.

▷ Password grabbing

If a user tends to reuse the same password for many sites, stealing it once from a low-security website means that they have access to all the sites the password has been used for.

◁ Phishing

Tricking a person into entering their credentials in a fraudulent website. Mockups often mimic legitimate social media sites or banks.

◁ Fake browser extensions

Tricking someone into downloading a malicious extension that tracks browsing habits or even posts from logged-in accounts.

◁ Keyloggers

Once downloaded, keyloggers record user key presses and send data, such as passwords, back to the original hacker.

